	Covert participation				
	Model 1	**Model 2**	**Model 3**	**Model 4**	**Model 5**
effects					
N	5122	4190	4190	4190	4190
Adj. R-squared	0.634	0.645	0.647	0.645	0.645

Note: Robust standard errors are clustered at the country level. Model specification is OLS.
***p <.001; **p <.01; *p <.05

6.4 Concluding Thoughts: The Role of Sidelining Constituents in Combating Populist Resistance

In this chapter, we uncovered how IOs counter populist resistance by sidelining their constituents, particularly by engaging with populist leaders through covert channels. This strategy encompasses a variety of methods aimed at reducing the domestic political costs that populist leaders face when cooperating with IOs. Using novel data, we demonstrated that populists rely on private interactions with IOs significantly more than their nonpopulist counterparts do. While secrecy mechanisms are not exclusively designed to address populist challenges, our findings reveal that IOs frequently leverage these channels in the face of populism.